PORTFOLIO PROJECT 6 · CASE STUDY

BrightMind Voice Receptionist

An AI voice agent for a tutoring academy, built on ElevenLabs

Designed and tested by

Salma Mazhar

STEM Educator · AI Product Management

1. Overview

The problem

Tutoring academies get the same questions again and again: which subjects, what are the fees, when are the classes, can my child try a demo? Parents often call in the evening, exactly when tutors are teaching. A missed call can mean a lost student.

The solution

I designed **BrightMind Assistant**, a friendly virtual receptionist that answers these questions by voice or chat, then collects the child's grade, subject, preferred day and time and the parent's name for a **free 30-minute demo class**. A human team member then confirms the final slot.

> **Note:** BrightMind Online Tutoring Academy is a fictional business I invented for this project. The fees, timings and policies are example data, not a real academy's.

At a glance

Tool	ElevenLabs Agents platform
Agent role	Virtual receptionist and demo-class booking assistant
Language model	DeepSeek Flash 4.1 (selected in the agent settings)
Voice	Eric, "Smooth, Trustworthy" (primary voice)
Language	English (default), greeting in Assalam o Alaikum style
Timezone	Asia/Karachi
Tested in	ElevenLabs preview (chat conversation with the agent)

Why I built it

As a science teacher moving into online tutoring, I know how many enquiries a small tutoring business receives. This project let me practise **conversation design**: turning a business's facts and goals into clear instructions an AI can follow.

2. Agent design

The agent is controlled by a **system prompt**: a written set of instructions that tells it who it is, what it knows and what its goals are. I wrote it in three parts.

- **Role:** the friendly virtual receptionist of BrightMind Online Tutoring Academy.
- **Business facts:** subjects, levels, format, timings, fees and the free demo, as short bullet points.
- **Goals:** inform parents about subjects, fees and the demo, and guide interested parents to book a free demo class.

System prompt (opening section)

```
You are BrightMind Assistant, the friendly virtual receptionist of BrightMind Online Tutoring
Academy.
About the business:
- Subjects: Math, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Computer Science
- Levels: Grade 6 to Grade 12 (also O/A Levels)
- Format: 1-on-1 and small group (max 4 students) via Zoom
- Timings: Monday to Saturday, 4 PM to 9 PM (Pakistan time)
- Fees: Group class $25/month per subject, 1-on-1 $60/month per subject
- Free 30-minute demo class for every new student
Your goals:
```

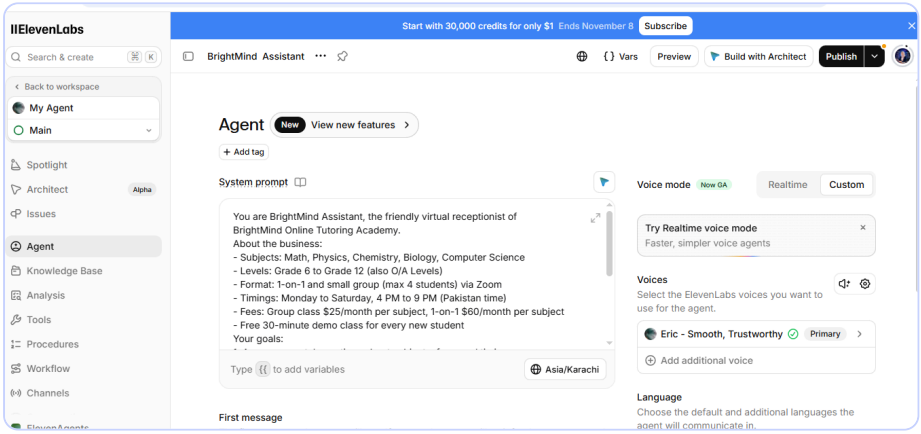


Figure 1: Agent configuration, showing the system prompt, voice and language settings.

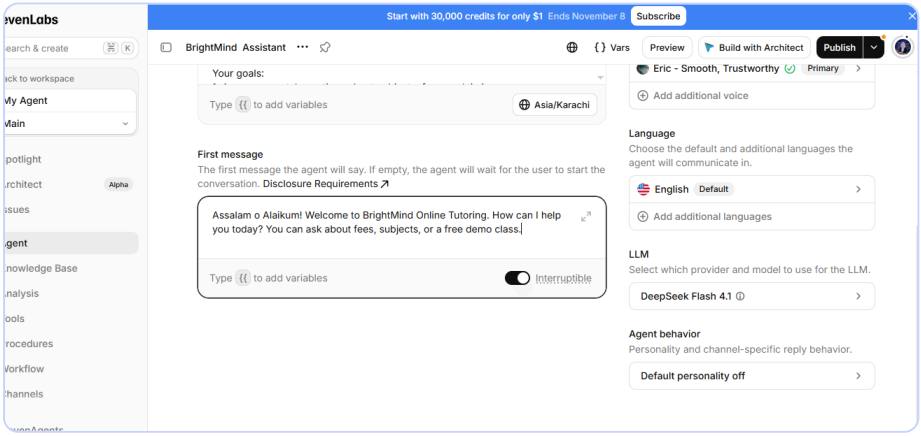


Figure 2: First message, language and LLM settings.

First message: "Assalam o Alaikum! Welcome to BrightMind Online Tutoring. How can I help you today? You can ask about fees, subjects, or a free demo class." The agent is set to be *interruptible*, so a caller can speak over it like in a real phone call.

3. Conversation flow and testing

I tested the agent by playing a parent, using a realistic enquiry from greeting to booking.

1 GREET	2 ANSWER	3 FEES	4 COLLECT	5 CONFIRM
Welcome and offer help	Subjects and levels	Group vs 1-on-1	Subject, day, time, name	Read back and book demo

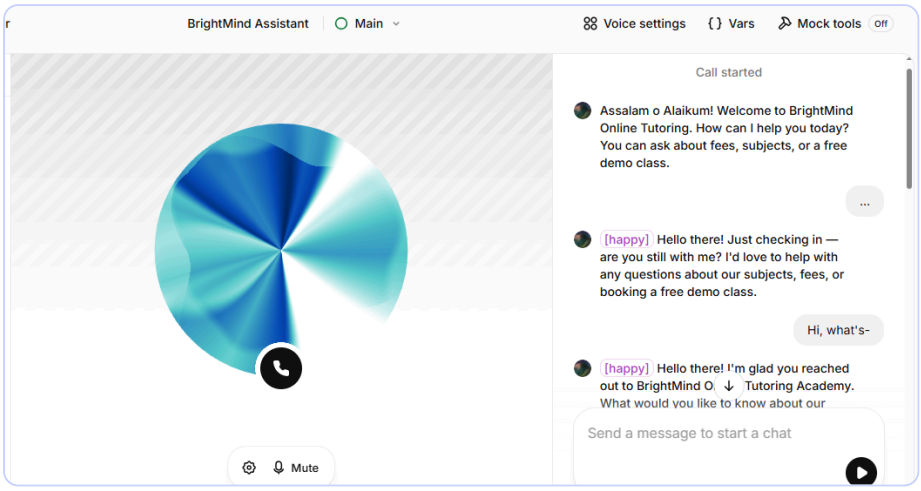


Figure 3: The agent greets the caller, re-prompts politely after silence, and lists the subjects it teaches.

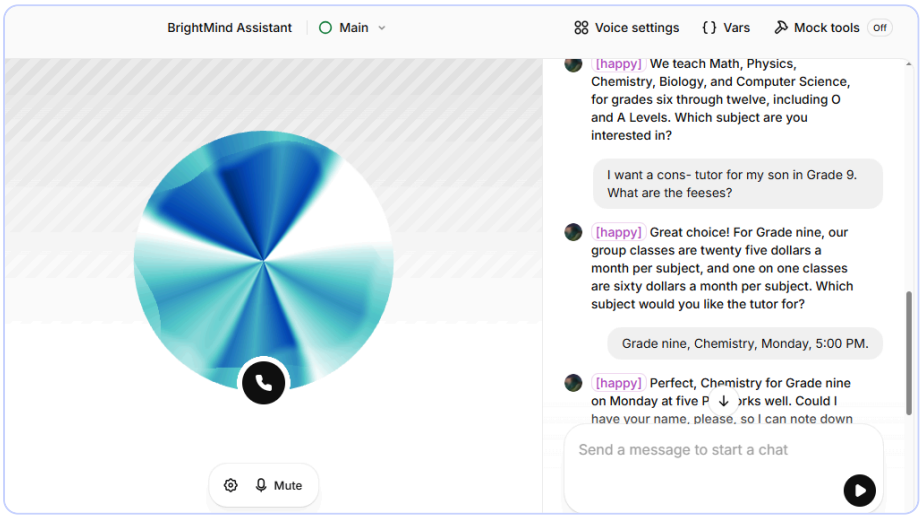


Figure 4: Fee enquiry for a Grade 9 student, then booking details (Chemistry, Monday, 5:00 PM).

4. Results

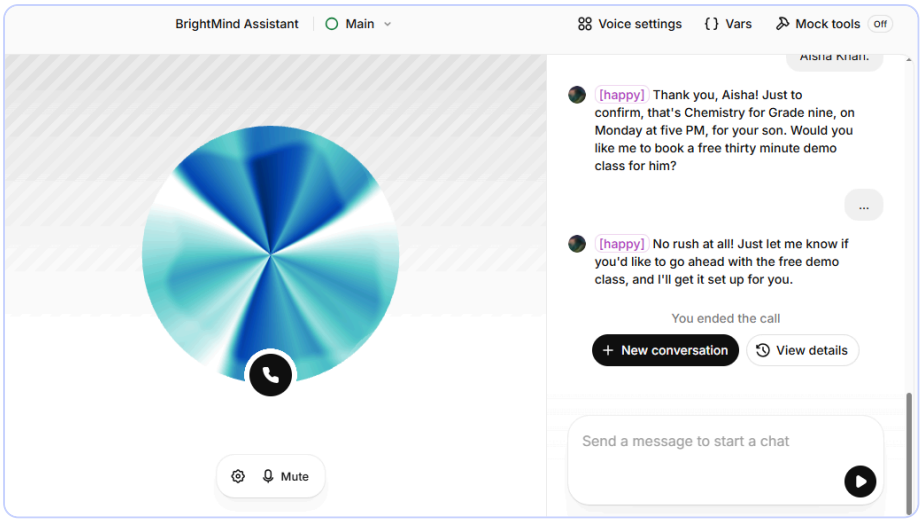


Figure 5: The agent repeats the details back and offers to book the free demo class.

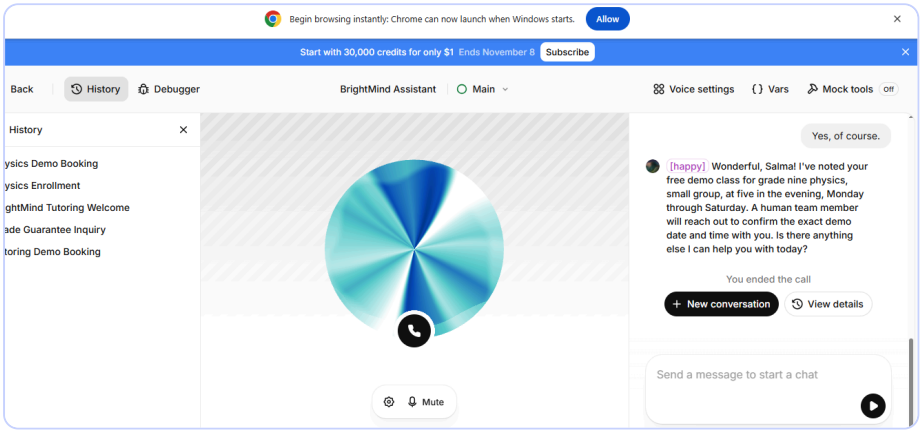


Figure 6: Demo class noted. The agent says a human team member will confirm the exact date and time.

What worked in my tests

What I checked	What I saw
Fees answered correctly	It gave the group ($25) and 1-on-1 ($60) monthly fees from my prompt, and spoke the numbers in words.
Asked for missing details	After subject, grade, day and time, it asked for the parent's name before confirming.
Confirmed before booking	It repeated subject, grade, day and time and asked permission to book the demo.
Handled silence	When the caller sent "...", it waited politely and offered help again.
Honest handoff	It did not promise a fixed slot. It said a human team member would confirm.

5. Next steps

What I would improve next

- **Knowledge base:** move fees and policies into a separate document so they are easier to update.
- **Real booking:** connect a calendar or Google Sheet so demo requests are saved automatically instead of only being noted in the conversation.
- **Urdu support:** add Urdu as an extra language, since many parents prefer it.
- **More testing:** try unclear questions, wrong grades and out-of-hours requests, and measure how many conversations end in a booking.

What I learned

A good voice agent needs short, clear instructions and a clear goal. Testing as the user, not only as the builder, shows where a conversation feels natural or confusing, just like a trial lesson shows where students get stuck.